

Limited Government

OPENING FRAME → START HERE

Government is a necessary servant and a dangerous master. Liberty, property, and thrift beat bureaucratic control.

DEBATE PATH

- 1 Warning: 1 Samuel 8 — centralized power taxes, conscripts, and takes.
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- 2 Economics: Property, work, and free exchange create wealth (Ex 20:15; Prov).
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- 3 Liberty: Free will implies government protects rights — it doesn't micromanage souls.
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- 4 Incentives: Bureaucracy wastes; markets discover knowledge government can't.
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- 5 Debt: Borrowing against children is generational theft (Prov 22:7; 13:22).

COUNTERS

THEY SAY

"Government provides necessary services"



YOU SAY

Yes — core ones: defense, courts, policing (Rom 13). Most else is better private or local.

THEY SAY

"Without regulation, exploitation"



YOU SAY

Fraud and force are already illegal. Competition and reputation discipline better than endless rules.

THEY SAY

"We need safety nets"



YOU SAY

Charity and family first. Government monopolies often trap poverty; civil society humanizes help.

THEY SAY

"The rich don't pay their share"



YOU SAY

The top earners already fund most income taxes. "Fair share" often means "higher share."

CLOSE → → Argue competence + morality: limited government is how free people flourish.